

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 407

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Dr. Christopher E. Townson for his leadership in the telecommunications and broadband industry.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should acknowledge and applaud those community leaders who are wholly devoted to enhancing the quality of life for their fellow citizens and improving and enriching the place they all call home; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Dr. Christopher E. Townson, who has distinguished himself as a leader in the telecommunications industry, most notably during his tenure as Chief Executive Officer of DTC Communications from May 2016 to January 2025; and

WHEREAS, with nearly three decades of experience in telecommunications and broadband, Dr. Chris Townson has consistently delivered strategic management, innovation, and financial stewardship while maintaining a people-first, servant-leadership approach; and

WHEREAS, under his stewardship, DTC Communications embarked upon and completed a transformative \$140 million Fiber-to-the-Home initiative, expanding the cooperative's service area by more than 300 square miles and achieving full fiber-to-the-premises coverage over four years ahead of schedule and under budget; and

WHEREAS, DTC Communications experienced remarkable growth under Dr. Townson's leadership, nearly doubling its annual revenue and increasing its overall valuation by 230 percent, while also securing over \$25 million in grant funding to support broadband expansion; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Chris Townson's experience extends to managing multi-divisional corporations and fostering strong relationships with boards of directors, regulatory agencies, and industry stakeholders, and he has played a pivotal role in founding and operating an

organization dedicated to helping electric cooperatives and municipalities enter the broadband space; and

WHEREAS, a scholar as well as a practitioner, Dr. Townson holds both a Master of Business Administration degree and a Doctorate in Organizational Leadership, underscoring his strategic vision and operational expertise; and

WHEREAS, his contributions to the telecommunications industry include his involvement in key industry associations, including NTCA – The Rural Broadband Association and the Tennessee Broadband Association, where he has served on various committees and shared his insights as a sought-after speaker; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his many professional achievements, Dr. Chris Townson serves faithfully as an elder at The Journey Church in Lebanon, embodying his dedication to faith, family, leadership, and community service; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Dr. Townson has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Dr. Christopher E. Townson for his outstanding contributions to the telecommunications industry and the people of Tennessee and extend to him our best wishes for success and happiness in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

